

MLB Scion — The June Problem

Diagnosis and recommended course of action for the remainder of June 2026

1. Bottom line up front

Do not switch the book to V123 StatsOnly, and do not turn the underdog plays off either. The first move misdiagnoses the cause; the second over-reacts to a tiny sample. The evidence supports a middle path: **reduce dog exposure for the rest of June, keep the favourite plays, hold capital, and commission a price-band decomposition before drawing any seasonal conclusion.**

The reason for caution in both directions is the same — the evidence base for “June is costly” is far thinner than it looks. **Consensus was actually +10.5% in June 2025** (faves +26.8% outweighing dogs -10.3%). The only clearly bad consensus June is the 2026 fortnight at -11.2% — and that is just 18 plays, with its worst cell (home dogs, -49.9%) resting on the same 4 plays that recur in every table. We have *one flattered-positive June and one tiny clean-negative June*. That is enough to de-risk and investigate; it is not enough to switch models or kill a proven signal.

On the new disagreement signal (Section 9): revert yesterday’s live addition and make consensus (Setup 4) the live spine. The signal is promising but unvalidated, dog-heavy, and untested in the live June regime — exactly the profile you should not be adding to the book mid-drawdown. Validate it forward; do not discard it. Detail in §6.

2. Context in brief

MLB Scion is a binary classifier of the home-team win for games inside a ± 150 line; the home-win probability drives edge versus the de-vigged price, selection, and stake sizing. Two LightGBM ensembles predict the same target on the same data, differing only in inputs:

- **V119 (line + stats, 15 models).** Market-anchored — the bookmaker home probability is its one Core feature (~24.8%). Strong on favourites.
- **V123 (stats-led, game line removed, 41 models).** Fundamentals plus a residual closing-line ratio; effectively market-blind, so its agreement with V119 is independent confirmation — the basis of the consensus edge.

Training: 2004 – 5 Jun 2025. Out-of-sample (OOS): 6 Jun 2025 – 5 Jun 2026 (1,770 games). Live production begins 6 Jun 2026. Selection thresholds were tuned *on* the OOS, so headline OOS ROIs are optimistic — which is exactly why June 2025 (inside that window) cannot be read as a clean confirmation either.

3. The production strategy and how it stakes

Setup 4 — Consensus only (play only when V119 and V123 independently back the same side) is the strongest setup on every risk-adjusted measure over the full outsample.

Strategy	Plays	% games	Win %	ROI (full)	ROI (2026)	Per-bet SR
V119 alone (line + stats)	357	20.2%	57.1%	10.3%	—	0.11
V123 alone (stats only)	526	29.7%	54.2%	9.5%	—	0.09
Setup 1 — Union (any signal)	572	32.3%	53.8%	6.7%	0.9%	0.07
Setup 2 — Consensus + V119-only	320	18.1%	58.8%	13.3%	8.9%	0.14
Setup 3 — Consensus + V123-only	444	25.1%	53.2%	7.4%	−0.2%	0.07
Setup 4 — Consensus ONLY	192	10.8%	60.4%	19.3%	12.0%	0.20

Full outsample, flat 1-unit stakes. The live policy full-stakes consensus DOGS (the +18.8% full / +19.1% 2026 core), half-stakes consensus faves, and never plays V123 alone.

The cell that carries the book the rest of the year is consensus dogs at full stake. That is also the cell that looks worst in June — which is why what we do with it now matters so much, and why we should be careful not to act on noise in either direction.

4. The June problem — what the data shows, and how thin it is

Broken out by side, the same pattern appears in both Junes and every variant: favourites win, underdogs lose. But the sample sizes demand humility.

4.1 June 2025 (inside the outsample)

Variant	Plays	Win %	ROI	Fave ROI	Dog ROI
V119 ensemble	44	56.8%	+7.5%	+26.8%	−13.7%
V123 ensemble	73	46.6%	−5.7%	+34.1%	−15.2%
V123 (−115 to 150 band)	54	48.1%	−1.8%	+34.0%	−9.9%
Consensus (Setup 4)	41	58.5%	+10.5%	+26.8%	−10.3%

June 2025. Note the consensus row: net +10.5% — the strategy was PROFITABLE this June, because winning faves outweighed losing dogs.

4.2 6–21 June 2026 (truly live, beyond the outsample — 208 games)

Variant	Plays	Win %	ROI	Home-Fave	Vis-Dog	Home-Dog
V119 ensemble	34	44.1%	−14.0%	−7.9%	−11.1%	−49.9%
V123 StatsOnly	47	51.1%	+4.9%	+33.8%	−38.3%	−49.9%
Consensus only	18	44.4%	−11.2%	+48.5%	−31.2%	−49.9%
Full Section-7 strategy	34	41.2%	−19.5%	−7.5%	−23.7%	−49.9%

6–21 June 2026. Favourites positive, dogs negative — but on tiny counts. Home-Dog is −49.9% on the SAME 4 plays (1 win) in every row; the visitor-dog damage is ~9–16 plays.

The crucial caveat both the original report and the proposal under-weighted: the live “June dog problem” in 2026 is roughly 13–20 dog plays losing, and its scariest single number (home dogs –49.9%) is 4 plays. June 2025’s thresholds were fitted in-window, so its +10.5% is flattered; June 2026 is clean but minuscule. You cannot switch models or kill your best signal on this. You can, sensibly, de-risk and investigate.

5. Is the V123 StatsOnly switch the right fix? Still no

- 1. It attributes to the model what belongs to side and season.** V123’s June-2026 profit is favourite-driven (home faves +33.8%); its dogs lose. Same fave-over-dog pattern as every variant.
- 2. V123 lost in the comparable June.** June 2025: –5.7% overall, –1.8% in the very –115 to 150 band being proposed. One positive fortnight does not make it a robust June performer.
- 3. The 2026 evidence is 47 plays, favourite-carried, and does not even reconcile.** V123’s reported sub-totals do not sum to its +4.9% headline — worth checking in the sheet before relying on it.
- 4. The logic is self-contradictory.** If V123 truly generalised better you would keep it past June, not revert in July. The reversion concedes June is a special regime — the right response to which is to adjust what you bet, not rotate models for a fortnight.

6. The disagreement signal (your Section 9) — promising, but not yet a live edge

The finding: on games where V119 and V123 take opposite sides, V123’s side is highly profitable (+20.7% full outsample) while V119’s side loses (–15.3%). The mechanism is clean and worth stating, because it is the same logic the rest of the system rests on.

V119 is market-anchored (the bookmaker probability is ~25% of its importance), so when it takes a side it largely echoes the market. V123 is line-free. So **“V123 disagrees with V119” is, in practice, “V123 is betting against the market’s lean”** — the purest form of the divergence your Implementation Plan says the edge comes from.

But the 37-vs-82 asymmetry tells you what that divergence concretely is. On a disagreement game, V119 leans to the line — typically the *visitor favourite*, which your no-VisFave policy bins, so V119 registers no play — while V123 takes the opposite *home dog*, which is allowed. So the signal is, almost entirely, **a home-dog-value play: V123 backing home dogs when V119 wants the disallowed road favourite**. That is a real and well-documented angle — road favourites are systematically overbet, and a line-anchored model misses the undervalued home dog precisely because it is following that road-favourite price.

Slice (outsample)	Plays	Win %	ROI full	ROI 2026*	Jun 2025
V119 disagrees with V123	37	43.2%	–15.3%	–15.1%	–34.3% (n=3)
V123 disagrees with V119	82	59.8%	+20.7%	+31.6%	–21.6% (n=13)

*“2026” here runs only to 5 June — it does NOT include the live 6–21 June lesion. Note V123’s disagreement edge already inverts in June 2025 (–21.6%, dogs –36.8%).

The decomposition resolves the earlier contradiction. Every V119-disagree game is also a V123-disagree game, so the overlap is exactly 37 — leaving **45 of the 82 (~55%) as games where V119 has no play at all** (its pick was a binned visitor favourite). Those 45 are V123 betting home dogs essentially solo. So roughly half the “disagreement” set is the very “V123-only / V119-silent” bucket your Implementation Plan rated -9.3% in 2026 and told you never to play alone. The +20.7% headline is mostly a statement about V123 home dogs, not about “disagreement” as an independent signal.

And the raw comparison is not like-for-like. V119-disagree (37) and V123-disagree (82) survive different policy filters — the no-VisFave ban spares V123’s side far more often — so “-15.3% vs +20.7%” is partly an artefact of which picks the policy happens to allow, not a clean test of skill on the same games.

Why it is not yet safe to run live — five reasons, and they rhyme with the StatsOnly case:

- **It inverts in June, dog-side.** June 2025 was -21.6% (dogs -36.8%), and the signal is 76% dogs (62 of 82) — and concentrated in home dogs specifically, which are the most June-fragile cell you have (-36.8% in June 2025; the -49.9% live cell in §4.2). Switching it on during the June home-dog lesion is maximally backwards timing.
- **It is a post-hoc slice of the threshold-tuned outsample, on small n** (82 full, 35 in 2026). At n=35 the win-rate confidence interval still includes breakeven — impressive, not yet proven.
- **It was never tested in the live June regime.** Section 9’s “2026” stops at 5 June, so the +31.6% says nothing about 6–21 June — yet that is the regime it was switched on into.
- **About half of it is V123 playing home dogs solo** (the 45 games where V119 is silent), which your own plan already rated -9.3% in 2026. The signal is not the independent confirmation that makes consensus strong; it is single-line-of-evidence home-dog exposure.

In fairness, the home-dog angle may be real. Road favourites are systematically overbet, so an undervalued-home-dog edge is plausible and worth validating — but as a home-dog-value strategy on a clean full season, with the no-VisFave filter applied symmetrically so the comparison is honest, not as a live slot taken mid-drawdown.

Decision. Revert yesterday’s addition — you are largely reverting V123-solo home-dog exposure at the worst possible moment. Run consensus-only (Setup 4) as the live spine, with the June dog de-risking in §9. Then validate the home-dog-value angle forward on a clean season, with the VisFave filter applied symmetrically, before deciding whether it earns a permanent place. Restrict to agreement now; keep the home-dog hypothesis open for outside June.

7. But is it really “June”? Decompose before concluding

This is the most valuable line of inquiry, and it is right: “June” is most likely a **label for a narrower regime**, not a cause. Treating the whole month as the unit of analysis is too coarse. Two things point to a narrower culprit already visible in the data:

- **Home vs visitor dogs behave differently.** The –49.9% home-dog cell is 4 plays in every variant — statistically meaningless. The visitor-dog cell carries most of the real volume (V119 –11.1% on 16; V123 –38.3% on 10; consensus –31.2% on 9). The damage is not “dogs”; it is concentrated and small.
- **The band already excludes part of the problem.** V123’s strong –115 to 150 result comes from removing the heavy-favourite region it cannot price. A price filter is doing real work — which suggests price band, not the calendar, is the right axis to cut on.

Candidate mechanisms worth testing (most plausible first):

- **Stat / feature staleness vs market adjustment.** By June the market has enough data to re-price teams aggressively, while rolling-window features still reflect April–May behaviour — a train-vs-serve drift that would hit exactly the teams whose true strength diverged from early-season stats. This is the strongest hypothesis and it is testable.
- **Pitcher-role instability.** Role changes, injuries, call-ups and shifting bullpen usage degrade pitcher features specifically in this window.
- **Public-money shading — but check the sign.** Heavier summer volume on favourites would lengthen dog prices and make dogs BETTER value, not worse — the opposite of what we see. So this mechanism as usually stated predicts the wrong direction; only a sharp-money-correcting-early-dogs variant would fit. Don’t assume it.

7.1 The test to run first (highest expected value)

Re-cut June 2025 and June 2026 (and ideally the full outsample) along price and side, not the calendar. The source tables you supplied do not contain these splits, so this needs running in the sheet:

Cut	Buckets to compare (June 2025 and June 2026 separately)
Dog price band	+100 to +125 vs +126 to +150 (then finer: +100/+115, +116/+130, +131/+150)
Favourite price band	–100 to –115 vs –116 to –150
Side	Home-Dog vs Visitor-Dog; Home-Fave vs Visitor-Fave
Membership	Consensus vs V119-only vs V123-only, within each band

If, say, +100/+125 dogs are roughly flat while +126/+150 dogs are –35%, then June is not a “dog problem” — it is a moderate/long-dog pricing problem you can excise surgically, preserving most of the long-run dog edge.

The pay-off is concrete: if one narrow band is doing most of the damage, you restore full stake on the safe dog band and trim only the harmful one — keeping the alpha instead of blunting all of it. Until that test is run, treat any blanket “June” rule as provisional.

8. The –115 to 150 band: real signal, but mind the framing

Restricting V123 to the –115 to 150 band lifts it from 526 plays / 9.5% to 344 plays / 20.4%, Sharpe 2.15 → 3.80. That is a large, mechanically-sensible improvement — the filter strips the heavy-favourite region a line-blind model cannot price. It is worth investigating as a structural change. Three disciplines before banking it:

- **Test it on the consensus book, not solo V123.** Your own plan concluded V123 must never play alone (solo dogs –10.3% in 2026, solo faves –12.7%). The 20.4% is a solo number for a strategy you don't deploy. The deployable question is whether a price filter improves Setup 4.
- **Discount the magnitude until forward-validated.** A filter found on the eval set that doubles ROI by dropping a third of trades is the signature of post-hoc subsetting. The mechanism gives it credibility; the size is likely flattered. Confirm on live data before sizing to it.
- **Keep it out of the June decision.** The band is a full-sample, dog-side property and it was –1.8% in June 2025. It does not rescue June — it is a separate, parallel R&D item.

9. Recommendation for 23–30 June — reduce and investigate

Graduated de-risking, not a model swap and not a shutdown.

Play type	June stake	Reasoning
Consensus Dogs	25–33%	Strongest proven long-run signal (+18.8% full / +19.1% 2026). Reduce to respect the regime, but do not eliminate — the bad evidence is ~13–31 dog plays across two Junes, one of which was net-positive overall.
Consensus Faves	50%	The one cell that wins in both Junes (+26.8% in 2025, +48.5% in the 2026 fortnight).
V119-only Faves	50%	Mild but durable standalone favourite edge (+4.8% full / +7.3% in 2026).
V123-only plays	0%	Plan rule: V123 never plays alone. Unchanged.
Disagreement plays (\$6)	Revert	Remove yesterday's addition from the live book. Promising but unvalidated, dog-heavy, and untested in the live June regime — validate forward before re-adding.
Wholesale V123 switch	No	Misdiagnosis; V123 lost money in June 2025. Do not switch the book.

Stakes are fractions of normal sizing. Hold overall June exposure modest — June is genuinely low-yield and the thresholds are outsample-fitted.

Why graduated rather than off: turning off the system's best long-run signal after one bad fortnight, on two June observations, is how edge gets accidentally killed. A 25–33% dog stake preserves the signal, keeps it generating data to test the seasonal hypothesis, and bounds the downside if the 2026 dog losses were largely variance — which, at ~13–20 plays, they may well be.

Reinstate full Setup 4 in July. The live collapse is concentrated in June dogs, not the strategy at large, so the year-round edge is most likely intact outside June — and the decomposition in \$6 may let you restore June dog stakes selectively even sooner.

10. Caveats and discipline

- **Two Junes, one of them flattered, is not a law.** June 2025's thresholds were fitted in-window; June 2026 is clean but ~18–47 plays. Log side $\times$ band $\times$ month rigorously this June; confirm against a third season before any permanent seasonal rule.
- **Headline ROIs are optimistic.** 19.3% full / 12.0% 2026 come from outsample-tuned thresholds; the first clean test (6–21 June live) was –19.5% on the full strategy. Size June conservatively regardless of which plays you keep.
- **Confirm the closing-line basis.** §8.1 results are on the closing line; ensure the favourite tilt survives at the mid-price you actually trade.
- **Fix the V123 reconciliation.** The June-2026 V123 sub-totals don't tie to the headline — close that gap so no decision rests on a reporting artefact.
- **The slice contradiction is resolved — but the lesson stands.** The disagreement (+31.6%) and V123-only (–9.3%) results overlap because ~half the disagreement set is V123 home dogs played solo; the no-VisFave filter explains the gap. Validate the home-dog angle on its own terms before any subset goes live, and apply the policy filter symmetrically so comparisons stay honest.

One line: the June problem is probably a narrow price-band of dogs in a specific regime, not “June” and not “dogs” wholesale. Reduce dog stakes rather than killing them, keep faves, hold capital, revert the just-added disagreement plays and run consensus-only as the spine, decompose by price band, and bring the full engine back in July.